

# ASK THE CORRIDOR DATA

Ask questions. Let your application find the data.

INTERMEDIATE   **ADVANCED**   →   DATA + TOOLS   **OPTIONAL: MAP / LLM / MCP**

## THE IDEA

The corridor dataset contains a lot of useful information, but a normal user should not have to search through JSON files to find an answer. You could build a tool where a person simply asks a question and your application finds the relevant data, combines it, and returns a useful response.

**THE QUESTION TO SOLVE** “Can a user ask a question about the corridor data and get a useful, evidence-based answer?”

## THE USER COULD ASK

| Question                                     | What the system might need                  |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Which corridors are interesting for a café?  | Business fit + whitespace + existing places |
| Where are morning commuters important?       | Audience score + morning activity           |
| Which corridors are strongest for families?  | Family audience + corridor context          |
| How is Corridor A different from Corridor B? | Data from both corridors + comparison logic |

## THE MINDSET

The goal is not to build “a chatbot”. The goal is to build a useful way to ask questions about the data.

**THINK IN THIS ORDER** Question → Find the right data → Analyze → Explain the result

EXAMPLE 04 / UNDERSTAND THE PROBLEM

1. WHY IS THIS USEFUL?

Raw data can answer many questions, but it is often hard to know where to look. A user may not know which file, field or combination of data points is needed.

| Without a tool                | With your tool                       |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Find the right file           | Ask a question                       |
| Find the right corridor       | Application finds relevant records   |
| Find audience / business data | Application combines the information |
| Compare everything manually   | Application returns a clear answer   |

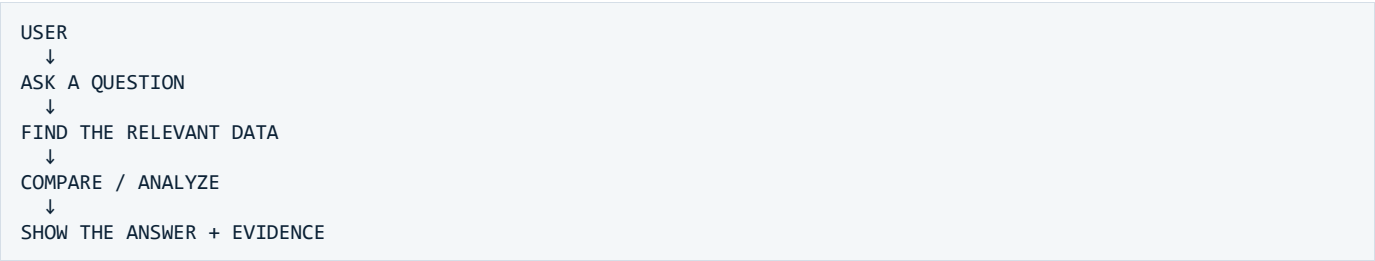
2. START WITH ONE SIMPLE QUESTION

**START HERE** “Which corridors are relevant for this question?”

Do not try to answer every possible question on day one. Pick one kind of question and make that experience work well.

- “Which corridors are most relevant for morning commuters?”
- “Which corridors look promising for a neighborhood café?”
- “Which corridors have strong residential and weekend activity?”

3. A SIMPLE WAY TO THINK ABOUT IT



Your first version can use ordinary programming. You can choose the question, fetch the relevant records, compare them and display the result. AI is not required for the basic idea.

4. WHAT SHOULD THE RESULT LOOK LIKE?

| Result    | What to show                                             |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Answer    | A direct response to the question                        |
| Evidence  | The important signals behind the answer                  |
| Details   | Corridors, audiences, places, fit or other relevant data |
| Next step | What the user could investigate next                     |

5. WHAT PARTS OF THE DATA CAN HELP?

| Data         | In simple words                                                                     |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Corridor     | A named commercial district in the dataset.                                         |
| Audience     | Groups that are relevant to the corridor, such as commuters, families or workers.   |
| Activity     | Relative activity across parts of the day, such as morning, evening or weekend.     |
| Places       | Existing places such as cafés, grocery stores, schools, hospitals and event venues. |
| Business fit | How well a business format appears to fit a corridor.                               |
| Whitespace   | A signal about potential opportunity, not a count of empty shops.                   |

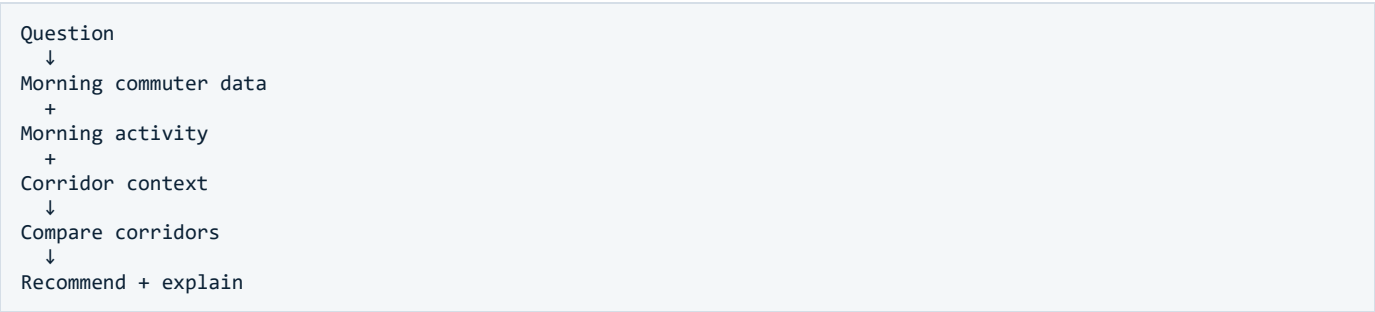
6. EXAMPLE: HOW ONE QUESTION BECOMES DATA

Suppose the user asks:

**USER ASKS** “Where should I look if I want to reach morning commuters?”

Your application might decide that it needs:

- Morning commuter audience scores
- Morning activity information
- Corridor details that help explain the result
- Places or anchors that add useful context



7. THE ANSWER SHOULD NOT BE JUST A SENTENCE

A strong result could include a short answer, a ranked list, the signals that support it, and a link or button to inspect the corridor in more detail.

| Weak                  | Better                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| “Corridor A is best.” | “Corridor A ranks highly because the selected audience is strongly represented and morning activity is also strong.” |
| One number            | Number + context + explanation                                                                                       |

## 8. BUILD A SMALL VERSION FIRST

**LEVEL 1 / INTERMEDIATE**

Support a small set of questions. Return a clear answer from the JSON data.

**LEVEL 2 / ADVANCED**

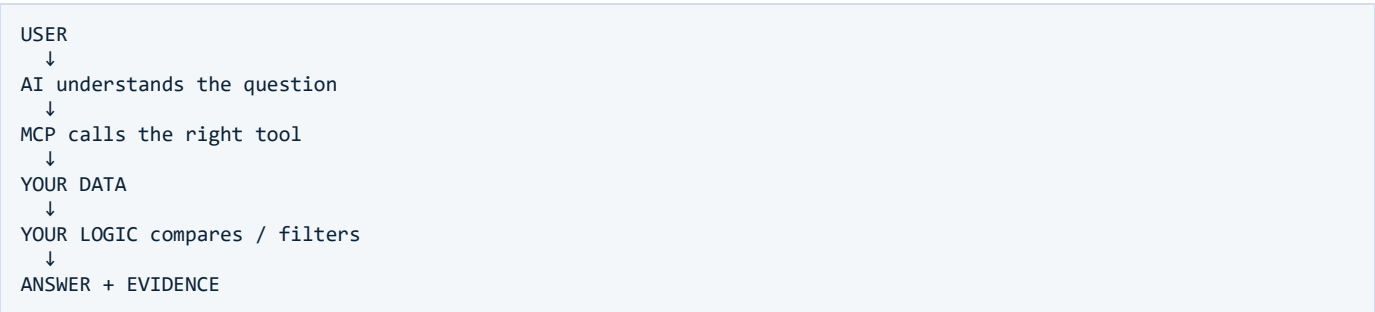
Let users ask more flexible questions. Add rankings, comparisons, tables, charts or a map.

**LEVEL 3 / AI + MCP**

Use an LLM to understand the question and MCP tools to fetch the right data before your application explains the result.

## 9. WHERE DOES MCP FIT?

MCP (Model Context Protocol) is a structured way for an AI model to use tools or data sources. Think of it as the bridge between the question and the data your application can access.



## 10. POSSIBLE TOOLS

| Tool                   | What it could do                       |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| search_corridors()     | Find corridors matching a basic search |
| get_corridor()         | Get information about one corridor     |
| get_audience_profile() | Return audience information            |
| get_fit_scores()       | Return business-format fit information |
| get_places()           | Return relevant places / place counts  |

**REMEMBER** MCP is the bridge. The useful product is the clear answer the user gets from the data.

# 11. MAKE THE ANSWER USEFUL

The strongest versions help the user move from a question to a decision. Do not stop at “here is the data”.

| User needs           | Your product can provide  |
|----------------------|---------------------------|
| “What did you find?” | Direct answer + evidence  |
| “Why?”               | Supporting signals        |
| “Show me.”           | Table, chart or map       |
| “What next?”         | A useful follow-up action |

# 12. QUESTIONS YOU COULD SUPPORT

- “Which corridors are strongest for families?”
- “Which corridors have strong morning activity?”
- “Where might a neighborhood café be worth exploring?”
- “How is Corridor A different from Corridor B?”

# 13. POSSIBLE EXTENSIONS

- Add maps, comparisons or clickable corridor details.
- Show the exact signals used for every answer.
- Generate a short report from the analysis.
- Add an LLM + MCP once the basic workflow is reliable.

**IMPORTANT** More AI does not automatically mean a better solution. Add complexity only when it improves the user experience.

# 14. THINK FROM THE USER’S PERSPECTIVE

Start with the user’s question, then choose only the corridor, audience, business-fit and place information needed to answer it. The final result should help the user decide what to investigate next.

# 15. WHAT NOT TO DO

- Do not build a generic chatbot that cannot reliably use the dataset.
- Do not let the AI invent facts or hide the evidence.

# 16. IMPORTANT DATA NOTE

Some values are contextual or expert assessments rather than direct measurements. Audience scores describe relative relevance, not a literal headcount. Whitespace is not a measured count of empty shops, and daypart information is a relative activity signal.

**USE CAREFUL LANGUAGE** “The available data suggests...” is better than “This is definitely the best corridor.”

# 17. YOUR CHALLENGE

**BUILD THIS IDEA IN YOUR OWN WAY** Create a tool that lets a user ask a useful question about the corridor dataset and receive a clear answer with supporting evidence.

You decide which questions to support, which data to use, what your interface looks like, and whether you add maps, AI or MCP. A small system that answers one class of question well is a strong starting point.